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SIR Model on a Network

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Introduction

Edge-based compartmental models (EBCMs) provide an exact, deterministic framework for tracking epidemics on configuration-model networks. Instead of simulating individual transmission events, we track the probability $\theta(t)$ that a random edge in the network has *not* transmitted infection by time t .

Combined with the network's probability generating function (PGF) $\psi(x) = \sum_k p_k x^k$ — which encodes the degree distribution — we can derive the fraction susceptible as $S(t) = \psi(\theta(t))$ and the fraction recovered $R(t)$ from a small system of ODEs.

The compact formulation (Miller 2011) for SIR on a configuration model network requires just two ODEs:

$$\dot{\theta} = -\beta\theta + \beta \frac{\psi'(\theta)}{\psi'(1)} + \gamma(1 - \theta)$$

$$\dot{R} = \gamma(1 - \psi(\theta) - R)$$

where β is the per-edge transmission rate and γ is the recovery rate.

Setup

```
using EdgeBasedModels
using ModelingToolkit
using OrdinaryDiffEq
using Symbolics
using Plots
```

Defining the network

We model a Poisson (Erdős–Rényi) network with mean degree $\kappa = 5$. The PGF is $\psi(x) = e^{\kappa(x-1)}$.

```
@parameters β γ κ
pgf = poisson_pgf(κ)
```

```
DegreePGF(z, exp((-1 + z)*κ))
```

We can verify the mean degree:

```
md = mean_degree(pgf)
println("Mean degree: ", md)
```

```
Mean degree: exp(0)*κ
```

Building the compact SIR model

The `build_sir` function constructs the edge-based ODE system. The `:compact` form produces just 2 ODEs.

```

model_compact = build_sir(pgf, β, γ; form = :compact)
eqs = ModelingToolkit.equations(model_compact.system)
println("Number of ODEs: ", length(eqs))
for eq in eqs
    println(" ", eq)
end

```

Number of ODEs: 2

```

Differential(t, 1)(R(t)) ~ (1 - R(t) - exp((-1 + θ(t))*κ)*(1 - ρ))*γ
Differential(t, 1)(θ(t)) ~ (θ(t)*exp(0)*β - (1 - θ(t))*exp(0)*γ - exp((-1 + θ(t))*κ)*β*(1 - ρ)) / (-exp(0))

```

The model returns an `EdgeModelSystem` with the compiled system, a dictionary of state variables, and a dictionary of observables:

```

println("State variables: ", keys(model_compact.variables))
println("Observables:      ", keys(model_compact.observables))

```

```

State variables: [:R, :θ]
Observables:    [:I, :ψ_θ, :S]

```

Solving the ODE

We anchor this network example to the well-mixed reference $R_0 = 2$ with $\gamma = 0.25$ and 1% initial infection. For a Poisson configuration model, $\kappa_{\text{excess}} = \kappa$, so $T = R_0/\kappa$ and $\beta = T\gamma/(1 - T)$.

[!NOTE]

$R_0 = 2$ anchor. Here $\kappa = 5$, so $T = 2/5$ and the comparable per-edge transmission rate is $\beta = 1/6 \approx 0.1667$, not the well-mixed mass-action value 0.5.

```

γ_val = 0.25
R0_target = 2.0
seed_fraction = 0.01
κ_val = 5.0
κ_excess = κ_val
T_val = R0_target / κ_excess
β_val = T_val * γ_val / (1 - T_val)
tspan = (0.0, 40.0)
prob = ODEProblem(

```

```

    model_compact.system,
    merge(
        default_initial_conditions(model_compact; seed_fraction = seed_fraction),
        Dict( $\beta \Rightarrow \beta\_val$ ,  $\gamma \Rightarrow \gamma\_val$ ,  $\kappa \Rightarrow \kappa\_val$ ),
    ),
    tspan,
)
sol = solve(prob, Tsit5(); saveat = 0.5)

```

retcode: Success

Interpolation: 1st order linear

t: 81-element Vector{Float64}:

0.0

0.5

1.0

1.5

2.0

2.5

3.0

3.5

4.0

4.5

⋮

36.0

36.5

37.0

37.5

38.0

38.5

39.0

39.5

40.0

u: 81-element Vector{Vector{Float64}}:

[0.0, 1.0]

[0.0014399022179882608, 0.999075792702776]

[0.00330479052210804, 0.9979444829456798]

[0.0056728644346913685, 0.996562885045385]

[0.00863739812055364, 0.9948803888053457]

[0.012307957084511942, 0.9928384407788843]

[0.016811022635182794, 0.9903704200407923]

[0.022289888351670357, 0.9874019493657514]

[0.028902800006613685, 0.9838523020427158]

```
[0.03681937099827079, 0.9796367017029504]
[0.7960875142237877, 0.6804095336702449]
[0.7965164504916639, 0.6803518307408477]
[0.7969001315406488, 0.6803019558484034]
[0.797243362317418, 0.6802588294883605]
[0.7975506516640795, 0.6802213207016677]
[0.7978262123181731, 0.6801882470747744]
[0.798073960912671, 0.6801583747396305]
[0.7982973825194334, 0.6801305764435367]
[0.7984980206635619, 0.6801056384400187]
```

Now we extract the population-level quantities using the model's named variables and observables rather than assuming a positional ordering in the ODE state vector. For a Poisson PGF, $S(t) = \psi(\theta(t)) = e^{\kappa(\theta-1)}$:

```
S_vals = compartment(sol, model_compact, :S)
I_vals = compartment(sol, model_compact, :I)
R_vals = compartment(sol, model_compact, :R)
```

81-element Vector{Float64}:

```
0.0
0.0014399022179882608
0.00330479052210804
0.0056728644346913685
0.00863739812055364
0.012307957084511942
0.016811022635182794
0.022289888351670357
0.028902800006613685
0.03681937099827079
0.7960875142237877
0.7965164504916639
0.7969001315406488
0.797243362317418
0.7975506516640795
0.7978262123181731
0.798073960912671
0.7982973825194334
0.7984980206635619
```

```

plot(sol.t, S_vals, label = "S", linewidth = 2, color = :blue)
plot!(sol.t, I_vals, label = "I", linewidth = 2, color = :red)
plot!(sol.t, R_vals, label = "R", linewidth = 2, color = :green)
xlabel!("Time")
ylabel!("Fraction of population")
title!("SIR on Poisson network ( $\kappa=5$ ,  $R_0=2$ ,  $\gamma=0.25$ )")

```

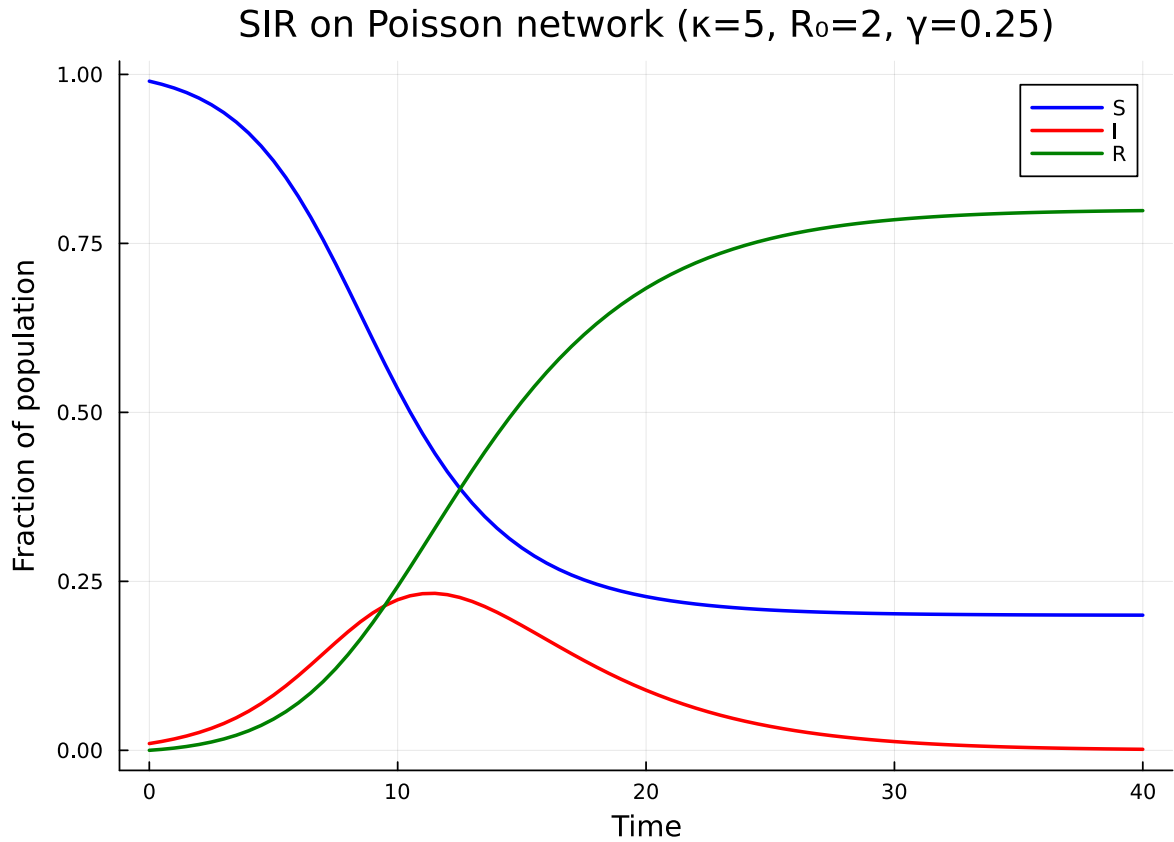


Figure 1: Figure 1: SIR epidemic on a Poisson network (compact formulation).

Expanded formulation

The expanded form tracks edge-level probabilities φ_I and φ_R explicitly, plus the population-level R . This form generalises to arbitrary disease progression graphs.

```

model_expanded = build_sir(pgf,  $\beta$ ,  $\gamma$ ; form = :expanded)
eqs_exp = ModelingToolkit.equations(model_expanded.system)

```

```
println("Number of ODEs: ", length(eqs_exp))
for eq in eqs_exp
    println(" ", eq)
end
```

Number of ODEs: 5

```
Differential(t, 1)(pop_R(t)) ~ pop_I(t)*γ
Differential(t, 1)(pop_I(t)) ~ -pop_I(t)*γ + exp((-1 + θ(t))*κ)*phi_I(t)*β*κ*(1 -
ρ)
Differential(t, 1)(phi_R(t)) ~ phi_I(t)*γ
Differential(t, 1)(phi_I(t)) ~ -phi_I(t)*(β + γ) + phi_S(t)*phi_I(t)*β*κ
Differential(t, 1)(θ(t)) ~ -phi_I(t)*β
```

```
println("State variables: ", keys(model_expanded.variables))
println("Observables:      ", keys(model_expanded.observables))
```

State variables: [:R, :φ_I, :pop_I, :pop_R, :φ_R, :θ]
 Observables: [:I, :φ_S, :S, :edge_hazard, :excess_hazard]

Let us solve the expanded model and verify it gives the same epidemic curve:

```
ic_exp = default_initial_conditions(model_expanded; seed_fraction = seed_fraction)
prob_exp = ODEProblem(
    model_expanded.system,
    merge(ic_exp, Dict{β ⇒ β_val, γ ⇒ γ_val, κ ⇒ κ_val}),
    tspan,
)
sol_exp = solve(prob_exp, Tsit5(); saveat = 0.5)
```

retcode: Success

Interpolation: 1st order linear

t: 81-element Vector{Float64}:

```
0.0
0.5
1.0
1.5
2.0
2.5
3.0
3.5
```

```
u: 81-element Vector{Vector{Float64}}:  
[0.0, 0.01, 0.0, 0.010000000000000009, 1.0]  
[0.0014399021800027027, 0.013124369819446343, 0.0013863109159751282, 0.01225375380615717, 0.  
[0.003304790164502933, 0.01681791158651909, 0.0030832753103818113, 0.014983909567052343, 0.  
[0.005672864702126067, 0.02119549079155389, 0.005155672162749442, 0.018275568555764225, 0.9  
[0.008637402072483787, 0.026383077696517702, 0.00767942009905562, 0.02222144627057546, 0.99  
[0.01230795211693954, 0.03251456778473226, 0.010742331291598753, 0.02691863441567388, 0.992  
[0.016811057190712315, 0.03972614363734472, 0.014444399387922613, 0.03246320184818603, 0.99  
[0.022289842075696033, 0.0481467886415562, 0.018897010509642143, 0.03894161320118202, 0.987  
[0.02890284518272256, 0.05788686548858747, 0.02422158315342179, 0.04642040541560705, 0.9838  
[0.03681949639159166, 0.06901747344189575, 0.030545014622238704, 0.054928612129756214, 0.97  
  
[0.7960656312947881, 0.0036319120902206137, 0.47937294990871604, 0.0007426268704818934, 0.6  
[0.7964958825820978, 0.003259850023623049, 0.479460116911464, 0.0006555377532806374, 0.6803  
[0.7968821762595987, 0.0029250032926672765, 0.47953720557188284, 0.0005785035991277106, 0.6  
[0.7972287945897161, 0.0026237977994360132, 0.47960526939140086, 0.0005104767368171584, 0.6  
[0.7975396152211061, 0.002353022268818472, 0.4796653014059663, 0.0004504684799805038, 0.680  
[0.7978182242985103, 0.0021097070007974625, 0.4797182208861627, 0.0003975631557031073, 0.68  
[0.7980679164627565, 0.0018911238704493853, 0.4797648733372089, 0.00035091810452416615, 0.6  
[0.7982916948507573, 0.0016947863279442375, 0.4798060304989588, 0.00030976368043671615, 0.6  
[0.7984922710955114, 0.001518449398545614, 0.4798423903459015, 0.0002734032508876299, 0.680
```

```
81-element Vector{Float64}:
 0.01
 0.013124369819446343
 0.01681791158651909
 0.02119549079155389
```



```

0.026383077696517702
0.03251456778473226
0.03972614363734472
0.0481467886415562
0.05788686548858747
0.06901747344189575
0.0036319120902206137
0.003259850023623049
0.0029250032926672765
0.0026237977994360132
0.002353022268818472
0.0021097070007974625
0.0018911238704493853
0.0016947863279442375
0.001518449398545614

```

```

plot(sol_exp.t, I_exp, label = "I (expanded)", linewidth = 2, color = :red)
scatter!(sol.t[1:4:end], I_vals[1:4:end], label = "I (compact)",
         markershape = :circle, markersize = 4, markerstrokewidth = 0,
         color = :black)
xlabel!("Time")
ylabel!("Fraction infected")
title!("Compact vs Expanded Formulation")

```

The two formulations give identical epidemic curves, confirming that the compact form (2 ODEs) is an exact reduction of the expanded form (5 ODEs after `mtkcompile`) for SIR.

Effect of transmission rate

```

betas = β_val .* [0.5, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0]
p = plot(xlabel = "Time", ylabel = "Fraction infected",
         title = "Effect of β on epidemic dynamics (κ=5, central R₀=2)")

for b in betas
    prob_b = ODEProblem(
        model_compact.system,
        merge(
            default_initial_conditions(model_compact; seed_fraction = seed_fraction),
            Dict{β ⇒ b, γ ⇒ γ_val, κ ⇒ κ_val},

```

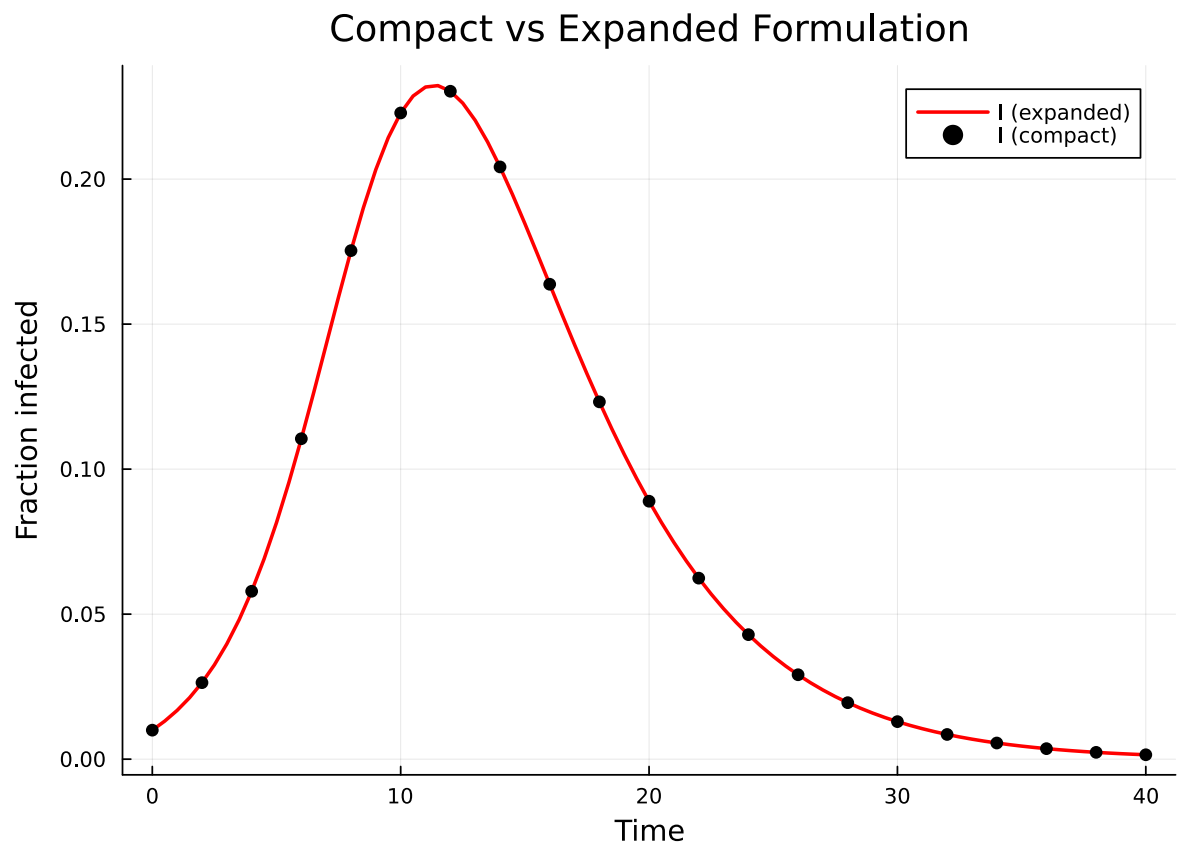


Figure 2: Figure 2: Expanded (line) and compact (markers) formulations overlap exactly.

```

    ),
    tspan,
)
sol_b = solve(prob_b, Tsit5(); saveat = 0.5)
I_b = compartment(sol_b, model_compact, :I)
plot!(p, sol_b.t, I_b, label = "β = $b", linewidth = 2)
end
p

```

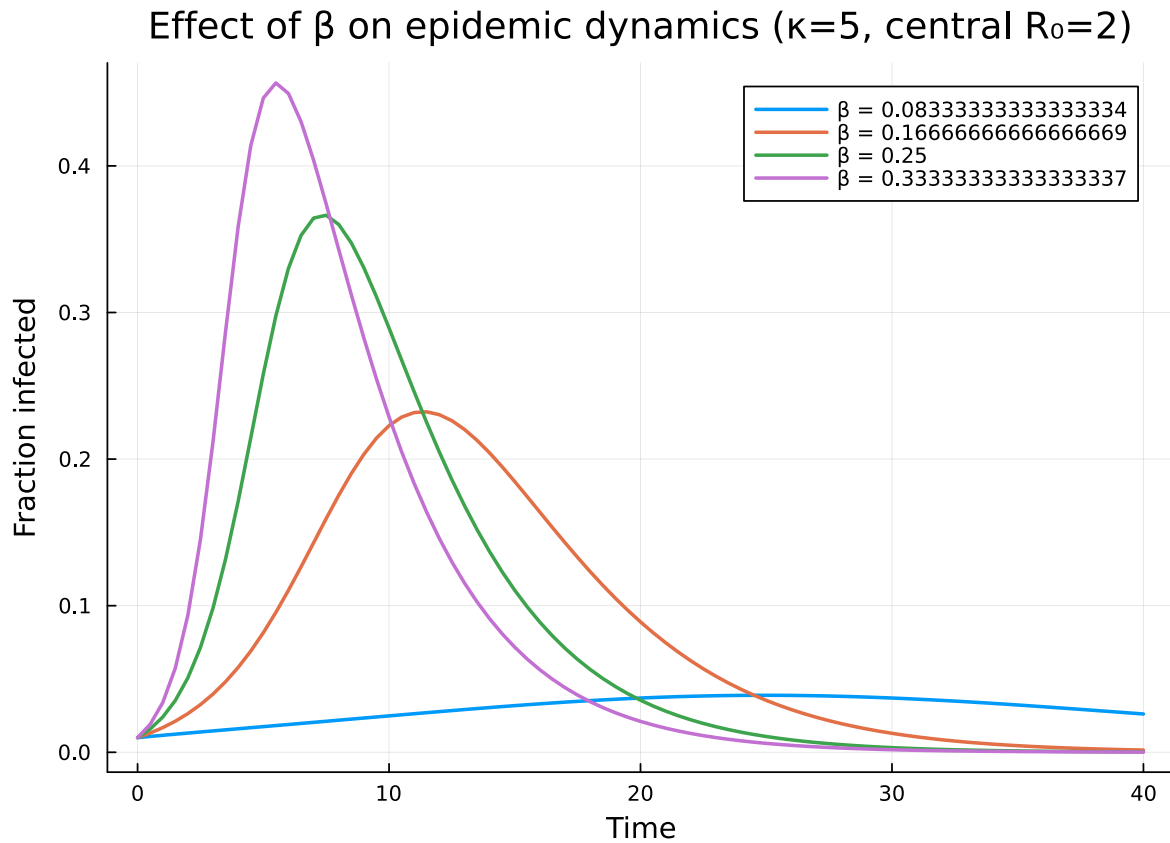


Figure 3: Figure 3: Effect of transmission rate β on the epidemic curve.

Simulation validation

To check that the deterministic EBCM is consistent with stochastic dynamics on a finite network, we simulate the same SIR process with the Gillespie SSA provided by [NetworkOutbreaks.jl](#) on

Erdős–Rényi graphs with the same mean degree $\kappa = 5$, and overlay the ensemble mean and $\pm 1\sigma$ band on the EBCM prediction.

To reduce conditioning on a single graph realisation, we average across several independent host graphs as well as across stochastic epidemic realisations on each.

```
using NetworkOutbreaks
using Graphs
using StableRNGs
using Statistics

N = 1000
n_graphs = 5
nsims_per_graph = 20
rng_host = StableRNG(20240501)

prog = sir_model()
no_model = OutbreakModel(prog, Dict{:β ⇒ β_val, :γ ⇒ γ_val})

tgrid = collect(0.0:0.5:40.0)
I_idx = no_model.index_of[:I]

I_runs = Matrix{Float64}(undef, n_graphs * nsims_per_graph, length(tgrid))
row = 1
for gi in 1:n_graphs
    g = erdos_renyi(N, κ_val / (N - 1); rng = rng_host)
    spec = OutbreakSpec(model = no_model, network = g,
                        initial = SeedFraction(:I ⇒ seed_fraction),
                        tspan = (0.0, 40.0))
    ens = simulate_ensemble(spec; nsims = nsims_per_graph,
                            seed = 20240501 + 1000 * gi,
                            parallel = true)
    for traj in ens.trajectories
        for (j, t) in enumerate(tgrid)
            I_runs[row, j] = Float64(state_at(traj, t)[I_idx])
        end
        row += 1
    end
end

μI = vec(mean(I_runs; dims = 1)) ./ N
σI = vec(std(I_runs; dims = 1)) ./ N
```

81-element Vector{Float64}:

```
0.0
0.0027703152283894456
0.00512644165483272
0.0075654985081465495
0.009203968182421661
0.012363595142533778
0.015003110788544266
0.017516776950896953
0.02104821545255972
0.025202330740379444
⋮
0.003592627130244621
0.003355742853826869
0.003159257680359279
0.0028562177434467073
0.0026376259604179485
0.0023066657908563763
0.002279819237916848
0.0020581446975272647
0.0019847906537954927
```

```
plot(tgrid, μI, ribbon = σI, label = "Gillespie SSA (mean ± 1σ)",
     color = :gray, fillalpha = 0.3, linewidth = 1.5)
plot!(sol.t, I_vals, label = "EBCM compact",
     color = :red, linewidth = 2)
xlabel!("Time")
ylabel!("Fraction infected")
title!("EBCM vs Gillespie SSA (Poisson κ=5, R0=2, N=$N)")
```

The deterministic EBCM curve sits inside the stochastic ribbon throughout the epidemic, confirming that the configuration-model closure correctly predicts the mean prevalence on this network ensemble.

Summary

- The compact formulation produces 2 ODEs and is the most efficient for SIR on static networks.
- The expanded formulation produces $1 + 2M$ ODEs (where M is the number of non-susceptible stages, so 5 ODEs for SIR) but generalises to arbitrary disease progression graphs (SEIR, multi-stage, etc.).

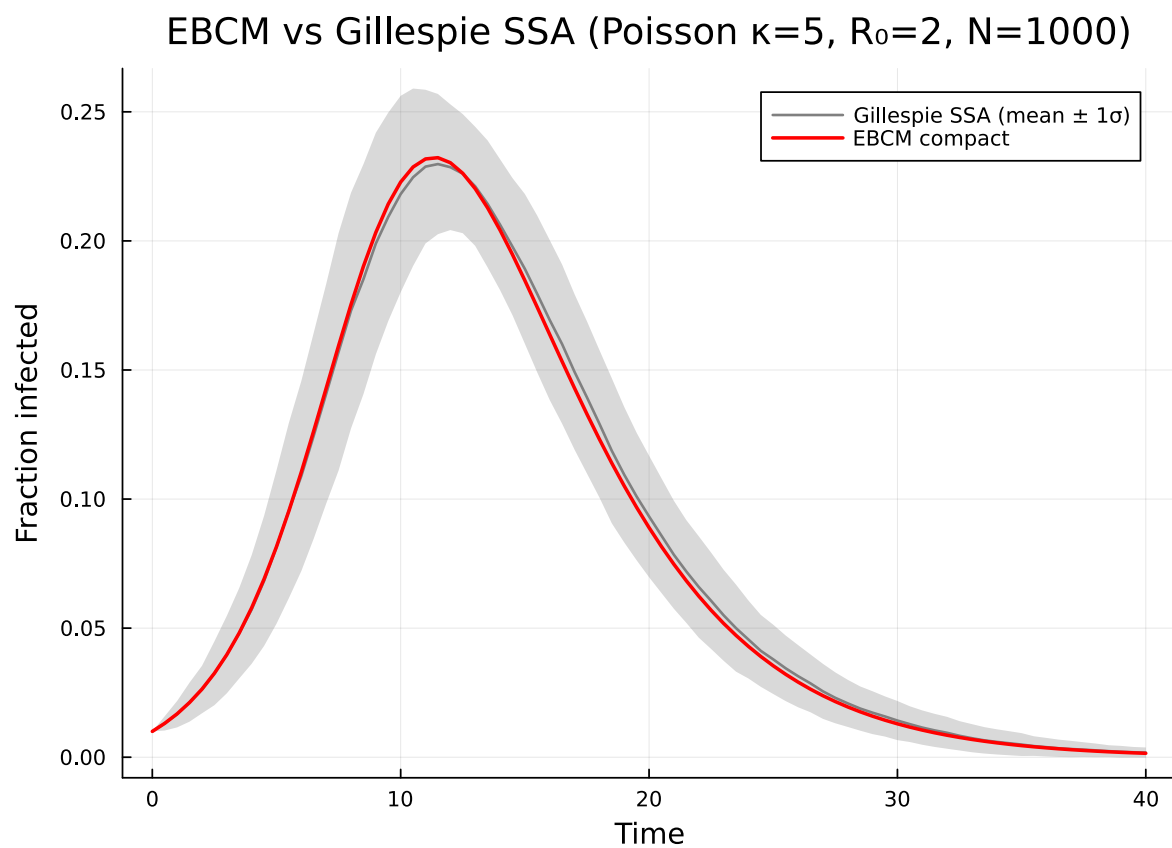


Figure 4: Figure 4: EBCM prediction (red line) versus Gillespie SSA on Erdős–Rényi graphs (gray ribbon: mean $\pm 1\sigma$ across $n_{\text{graphs}} \times n_{\text{sims_per_graph}}$ runs at $N=1000$).

- Both formulations give identical results for SIR.
- The PGF encodes the network's degree distribution — we used a Poisson PGF here, but the package supports arbitrary degree distributions via `polynomial_pgf`.
- The EBCM ODE prediction agrees with Gillespie SSA on finite Erdős–Rényi graphs with matching mean degree.